Sora Kim

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Research Focus

Responsibility is produced, not assigned. My research program—**Accountability-Aware AI**—studies how regulated organizations structure responsibility before failures occur, and how AI systems reshape what can be known and attributed. Drawing on four years of embedded practice in pharmaceutical Good Manufacturing Practice (GMP) quality control, I have independently produced 14+ papers, deployed 8 production tools serving 50+ users, and built a research infrastructure spanning ethnographic, computational, and design methods.

Education

Chungbuk National University *Cheongju, South Korea*
B.A. in English Literature March 2015 – August 2022

Honors & Awards

- **Top-Ranked Admission, Humanities & Social Sciences Division**, Chungbuk National University, 2015.
- **Full Merit Scholarship**, Chungbuk National University (8 semesters; tuition & fees; merit-based).

Industry Research Experience

GMP-Regulated Pharmaceutical Manufacturing Site *Seoul, South Korea*
Quality Control / Quality Systems September 2022 – Present

- Embedded practitioner-researcher in regulated biomanufacturing quality operations (4+ years as of application cycle).
- Conducted sustained ethnographic observation of Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) use, regulatory deviation handling, Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA) processes, and regulatory audit workflows.
- Designed and deployed 8 productivity tools serving Quality Control (QC) operations (see Deployed Systems).

- Trained QC colleagues and managers in AI-assisted workflow integration.
- Observational data and fieldwork form the empirical foundation of the STS research program below.

Deployed Systems

Production tools designed and deployed at a GMP-regulated pharmaceutical manufacturing site. All systems operate as unvalidated productivity layers external to validated GMP systems, with team lead awareness and support. These systems constitute the empirical substrate for the HCI papers below.

- **QC Stability Dashboard** — Deadline-tracking interface for stability testing programs; 53 active users, ongoing operation.
- **SOP Retrieval System** — Semantic search tool for GMP procedural documents; basis for *From Retrieval to Reasoning* (see Publications).
- **Document Navigation Tool** — Cross-document linking interface for regulated quality documentation; basis for *When Documents Don't Connect*.
- **Review Dashboard** — Prioritized document review interface surfacing procedural friction before formal deviation; basis for *Friction Before Failure*.
- **Root Cause Analysis (RCA) Scaffolder** — Investigative scaffold that preserves analyst judgment while structuring causal reasoning; basis for *Keeping Comparison Open*.
- **Veeva Vault Change Control Assistant** — Workflow support for electronic change control submissions.
- **Reagent Inventory & Expiry Management Tool** — Automated expiry tracking and inventory alerts for QC reagents.
- **Document Auto-Review AI** — Format and compliance pre-check for procedural documents.

Publications

Under Review at Peer-Reviewed Journals

A four-paper lifecycle theory of accountability in regulated organizations: pre-action structuring (AAC), procedural document infrastructure (CF), investigative convergence (RC), and AI-accelerated closure (PAC).

Kim, S. (2026). *Accountability Before Action: How Organizations Structure Responsibility in Advance of Outcomes.* Under review at **Academy of Management Review** (AMR-2026-0516). SSRN: 6371980

Kim, S. (2026). *Cognitive Friction: Procedural Documents as Accountability Infrastructure in Regulated Organizations.* Under review at **Organization** (ORG-26-0241). SSRN: 6391278

Kim, S. (2026). *Responsibility Convergence: How Investigative Systems Stabilize Attribution.* Under review at **Organization Science** (ORSC-MS-2026-22511). SSRN: 6372301

Kim, S. (2026). *Premature Accountability Convergence: How Technology Accelerates Responsibility Stabilization in Organizations.* Under review at **Information and Organization** (INFORG-D-26-00222). SSRN: 6391379

In Preparation — HCI & Design Research

Five HCI papers on judgment-preserving design in regulated work, each tied to a deployed production tool (see Deployed Systems*). Together they articulate a four-layer framework for accountability infrastructure design.*

Kim, S. (2026). *Accountability Infrastructure Design: A Four-Layer Framework for Judgment-Preserving Systems in Regulated Work.* In preparation for submission to **ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI)**.

Kim, S. (2026). *Keeping Comparison Open: An RCA Scaffolder for Preserving Interpretive Alternatives in Regulated Investigations.* In preparation for submission to **CSCW 2027**.

Kim, S. (2026). *Friction Before Failure: Dissociating Procedural Legibility from Procedural Endorsement.* Working paper (SSRN).

Kim, S. (2026). *From Retrieval to Reasoning: AI-Assisted SOP Access and the Shape of Interpretive Action.* Working paper (SSRN).

Kim, S. (2026). *When Documents Don't Connect: The Human as Missing Infrastructure in Regulated Document Systems.* Working paper (SSRN).

Working Papers — Computational Research

A computational research program operationalizing accountability across four signal layers (detection, graph structure, attribution, distribution), applied to FDA Warning Letters and synthesized in the umbrella paper.

Kim, S. (2026). *Responsibility as Multi-Layer Signal: A Computational Framework for FDA Warning Letters.* Working paper (SSRN). [Umbrella]

Kim, S. (2026). *Premature Convergence Detection in Regulatory Investigative Texts.* Working paper + GitHub: sorakim-lab/premature-convergence-detection.

Kim, S. (2026). *Accountability Graph Extraction from Regulatory Texts.* Working paper (SSRN).

Kim, S. (2026). *Responsibility Attribution Prediction: A Classification Approach to FDA Warning Letters.* Working paper (SSRN).

Kim, S. (2026). *Responsibility Distribution Metric: An Entropy-Centrality Approach to Accountability Structure.* Working paper (SSRN).

Conference Presentations

- **4S (Society for Social Studies of Science) Annual Meeting**, Toronto, 2026 (Panel 74). *Premature Accountability Convergence.*

Research Corpus & Data Infrastructure

- **FDA Warning Letters Corpus** — N=50 letters, 160 violations (2016–2025). Used across STS and computational papers.
- **Cognitive Friction Corpus** — 400 naturally occurring sentences from regulated procedural documents, manually annotated at sentence level.
- **Field Observation Archive** — Four years of notes on SOP use, deviation handling, and CAPA in a GMP-regulated site.

Methods & Technical Skills

Research Methods: Ethnographic fieldwork; document & corpus analysis; within-subject experimental design; think-aloud protocols; behavioral logging; qualitative coding; annotation protocol design; causal reasoning analysis.

Computational: Python, R, Stata; NLP & text processing (TF-IDF, sentence-level annotation, classification); Streamlit (deployment); LaTeX; HTML/CSS; Git/GitHub.

Regulated-Environment Systems: Veeva Vault QMS; GMP documentation systems; electronic change control; deviation/CAPA workflows.

Languages: Korean (native); English (fluent); Japanese (fluent).

Last updated: April 2026